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9 From this drill point, mark the blank with all the dimensions for the various pillar elements. The shaded area on the left will be the tenon to locate in the hole drilled in the base

10 To drill the hole through the blank, mount a Jacobs chuck (with a 5mm drill bit inserted) in the headstock. The drill points have been marked and centre punched, so position the blank as shown and locate the tailstock point in the opposing position. By advancing the tailstock, slowly drill the hole halfway through and then turn the blank and drill from the other side. This procedure will ensure the hole is drilled dead centre. Safety tip: an alternative way to secure the wood while drilling is to bring up the tool rest to give support and stop the blank from spinning. This will keep your fingers completely away from the drilling process and allay any safety concerns you may have

11 Remount the blank between centres and starting from the tailstock end, turn the various pillar elements. Take your time over this and frequently use your Vernier callipers to check diameters and lengths. At this point you can gently use a burning wire to burn lines between the various elements: I feel this adds crispness to the finished pillar. Whilst you still have tailstock support, sand to 400 grit and seal. Removing the waste area from the finial point needs the support of your hand on the pillar, so when you have turned away as much as possible, withdraw the tailstock and gently hold the pillar with your left hand. Finish this area with a skew or a detail gouge, then sand and seal the tip of the finial

12 Next, remove the tailstock support to finish the point...

13 ... then get ready to part off the completed pillar. Now repeat this whole process for the second pillar. Take your time and keep using your vernier callipers and steel rule so you can make an exact duplicate

14 It's now time to turn the clock barrel. Mount the blank onto a screw or glue chuck. True up the face and make a spigot to suit your chuck jaws. Remount onto your chuck and turn to round

15 The first job is to turn the recess for the clock insert. Do this carefully and keep offering the insert to the recess until the fit is comfortable but not too tight

16 Now follow the plans and turn the rest of the barrel rim using your small bowl and spindle gouge

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